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Selecting Important Data for Your Model

If you want to use models to score events, as part of your feature engineering work you need to find out which fields in your clean data source relate directly with fraud (or any other target variable). This will help you decide which fields to use in your models.

To examine your data source and discover which fields you can directly use as model features, execute the following actions:

1. In the **Data Science** tab, select your data source from the **Data Sources** list.
2. Use the option to generate statistics for the data source. Select which are the breakdown fields and values to slice the results into. For example, the *Fraud* field.

3. Use the **View Statistics** option for the field you want to inspect, to go in depth into the generated insight. For example, you can select the *TransactionAmount* field. When looking into the analysis details to understand the data, you can do the following:
 1. Use the **Breakdown Fields** dropdown to break down the statistics by *Fraud*.
 2. Examine results for both **Breakdown Values**. Usually, fraud is correlated with higher transaction amounts. Thus, if when you look at statistics for fraudulent transactions you find that the *TransactionAmount* is generally higher than for non-fraudulent ones, then it is likely that the *TransactionAmount* field will make sense as a feature.

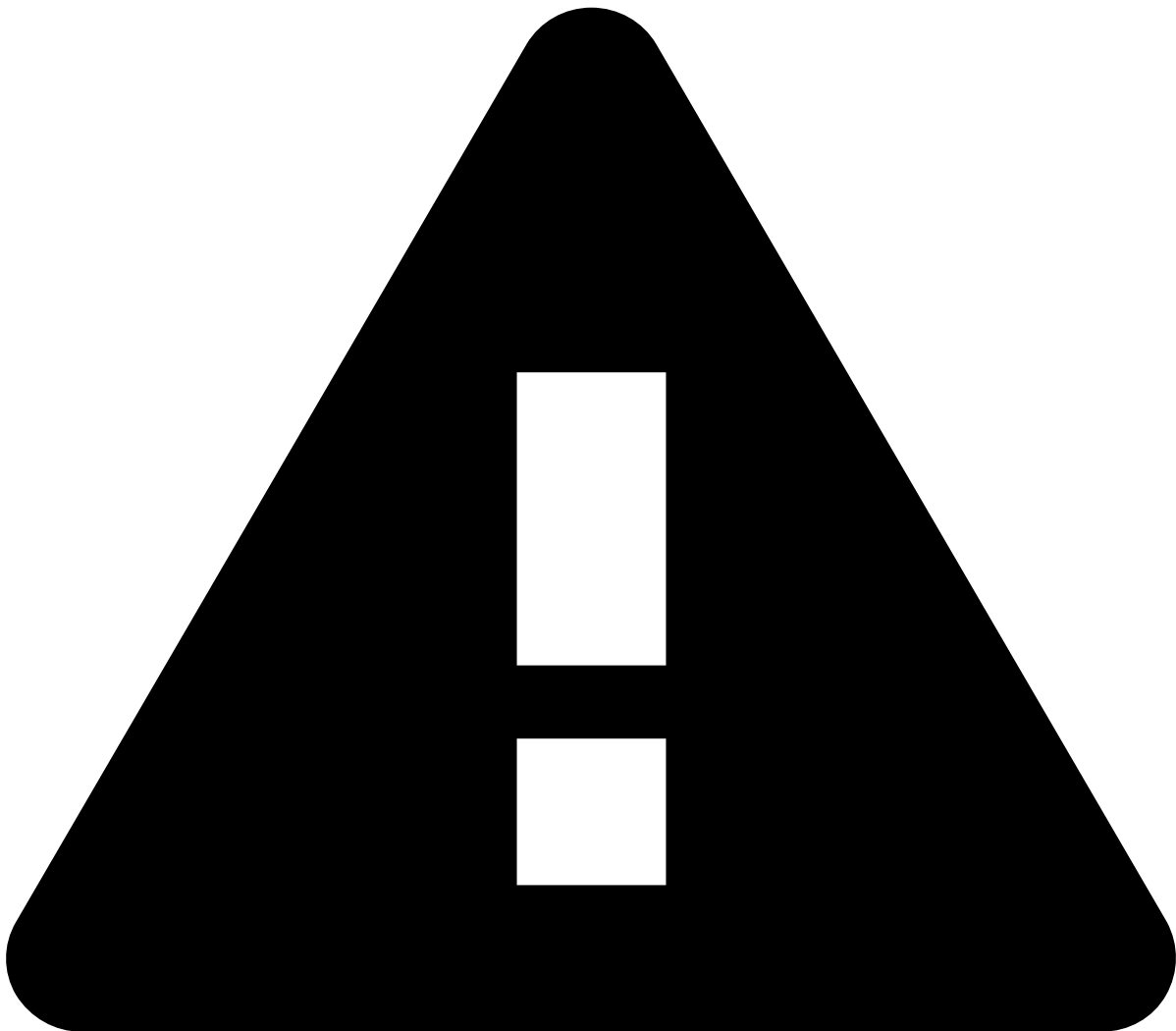
The following screenshot shows an analysis for events where *Fraud*=true:

The following screenshot shows an analysis for events where *Fraud*=false:

Generated statistics

Depending on the data types you defined for each field when [importing your data](#), Pulse generates different metrics.

For numerical fields Pulse generates arithmetic metrics such as mean, minimum and maximum, while for categorical data Pulse only generates the total count and distinct values.



Breakdowns

When you run an analysis on a data source, you must always select for which breakdown fields and values you want Pulse to calculate statistics.

Skipping this action and simply calculating broken-down metrics for all possible combination of fields and values could rapidly cause Pulse to crash due to lack of computational resources.